

STATE OF NEW YORK

1349--A

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN SENATE

January 9, 2025

Introduced by Sen. CLEARE -- read twice and ordered printed, and when printed to be committed to the Committee on Education -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the education law, in relation to requiring school districts to provide information regarding water safety and swimming certification to certain parents or students upon enrollment

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

1 Section 1. The education law is amended by adding a new section 926 to
2 read as follows:

3 § 926. Water safety and swimming certification. 1. Beginning with the
4 two thousand twenty-six--two thousand twenty-seven school year, each
5 school district shall provide, to a parent or guardian who initially
6 enrolls their child in the school, information on the important role
7 water safety education courses and swimming lessons play in saving
8 lives. The information must be provided electronically or in hard copy
9 and must include local options for age-appropriate water safety courses
10 and swimming lessons that result in a certificate indicating successful
11 completion, including courses and lessons offered for free or at a
12 reduced price. If the student is eighteen years of age or older, or is
13 under the age of twenty-one and is enrolling in adult education classes,
14 the information must be provided to the student.

15 2. For the purposes of this subdivision, the term "water safety" shall
16 mean age-appropriate education intended to promote safety in, on, and
17 around bodies of water and reduce the risk of injury, including fatal or
18 non-fatal drowning.

19 § 2. This act shall take effect July 1, 2026.

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets
[-] is old law to be omitted.

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